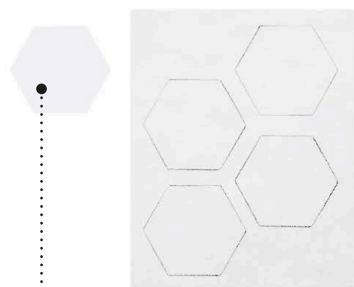


▶ ENGLISH PAPER PIECING

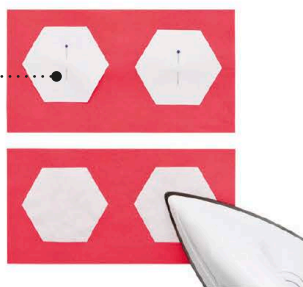
This is a traditional method for making a quilt of mosaic shapes. The fabric pieces – hexagons, honeycombs, diamonds, and triangles, all of which have at least two bias edges – are tacked to pre-cut paper templates the

size of the finished element. The technique is usually done by hand. The backing papers can be cut from virtually any heavy paper, but freezer paper can be ironed on quickly and is easy to remove.

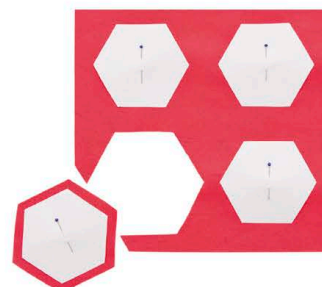
BASIC PAPER-PIECING TECHNIQUE



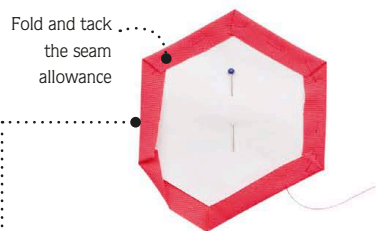
1 Unless you are using pre-cut paper shapes, make a template. Draw around it to make the necessary number of shapes. Using paper scissors, carefully cut out the backing papers.



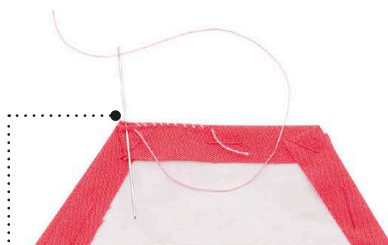
2 Pin a plain-paper shape or iron a freezer-paper shape (paper side up) to the wrong side of the fabric. Leave enough space for seam allowances.



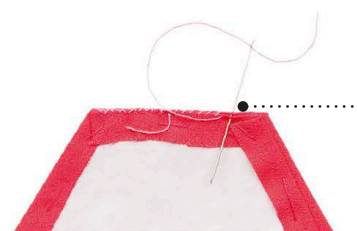
3 Cut out each shape from fabric, leaving a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance all around. You can use scissors or a rotary cutter, but take care to keep at least one side of the shape along the straight grain of the fabric.



4 Turn the seam allowance to the wrong side over the edge of the paper shape. Fold the seam allowance in each corner neatly and place a few tacking stitches through the wax paper and fabric, holding it securely in place.



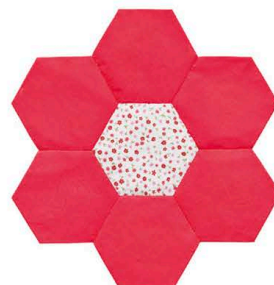
5 To join patches into units, place two shapes right sides together. Make a backstitched loop (see p.40), and oversew to the corner as close to the fold as possible. Do not sew through the backing papers.



6 Oversew along the same edge to the opposite corner, again taking small stitches. When you reach the corner, backstitch in the opposite direction for 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in).



7 Continue adding shapes until complete. If you wish to reuse papers, you can remove them once all the shapes adjoining a particular piece have been added by clipping the tacking stitches and carefully pulling the paper out.



RIGHT SIDE